

DOCUMENTATION PLAN

CCS How-To Guides

One job, start to finish, at the control station — built from the same DITA topics as the SUM.

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No CUI, classified, proprietary, or export-controlled information is contained in this document. Provided as a technical writing sample — Nathan B. Smith.

References

Each source and its purpose in this plan

REFERENCE	PURPOSE
OASIS DITA 1.3 — task topic	Defines the step structure every How-To uses (prereq, steps, result)
MIL-STD-498 SUM DID	SUM Section 5.3 procedures are the source the guides are cut from
ASD-STE100 (optional)	Controlled-language rules: one instruction per step, approved verbs
DoDI 5200.48 (CUI)	Markings on every printed card and HTML5 page
CCS SUM DITA outline	Companion plan: shared topic pool, filtering attributes, build rules
NAVAIR — CCS	System context: functions and platforms the guides cover

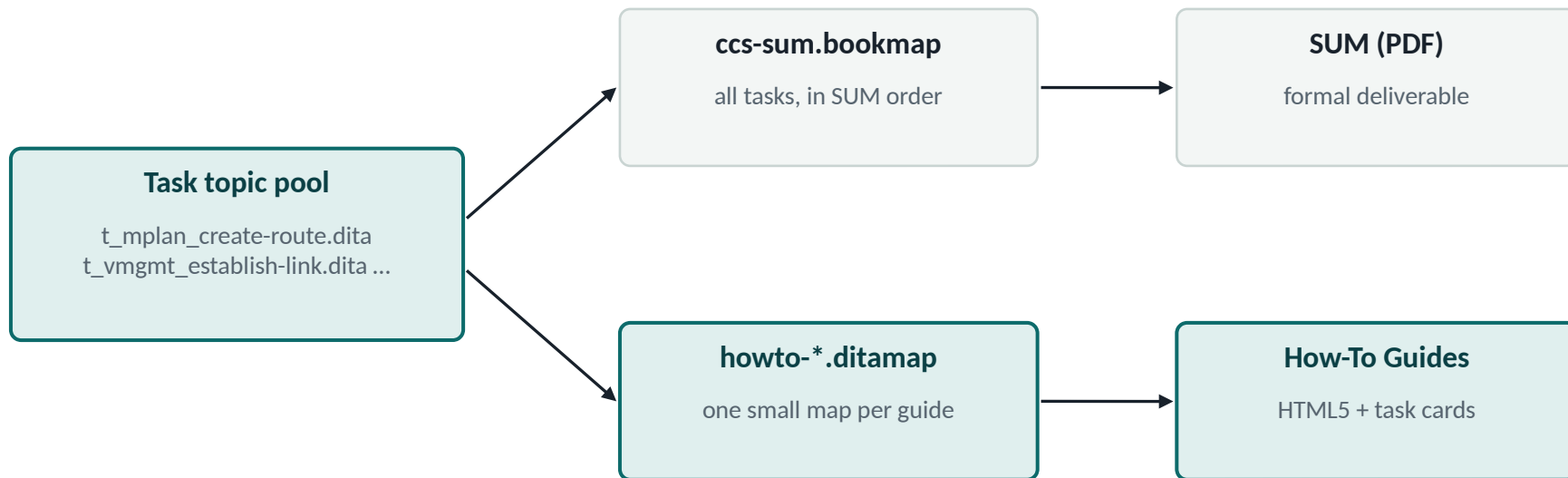
SUM vs. How-To Guide

Same content, different job

	SUM	HOW-TO GUIDE
Purpose	Complete reference for the software	Get one task done right now
Reader moment	Learning, looking something up	At the station, mid-mission
Scope	Every function, mode, message	One task, start to finish
Length	Hundreds of pages	1-2 pages per guide
Deliverable	Formal CDRL (PDF)	Offline HTML5 + printable task cards

Write once, publish twice

How-To Guides reuse the SUM's task topics — no second copy to keep in sync



A guide map adds only what the SUM doesn't need: an “Applies to” line, a verify step, and links to troubleshooting.

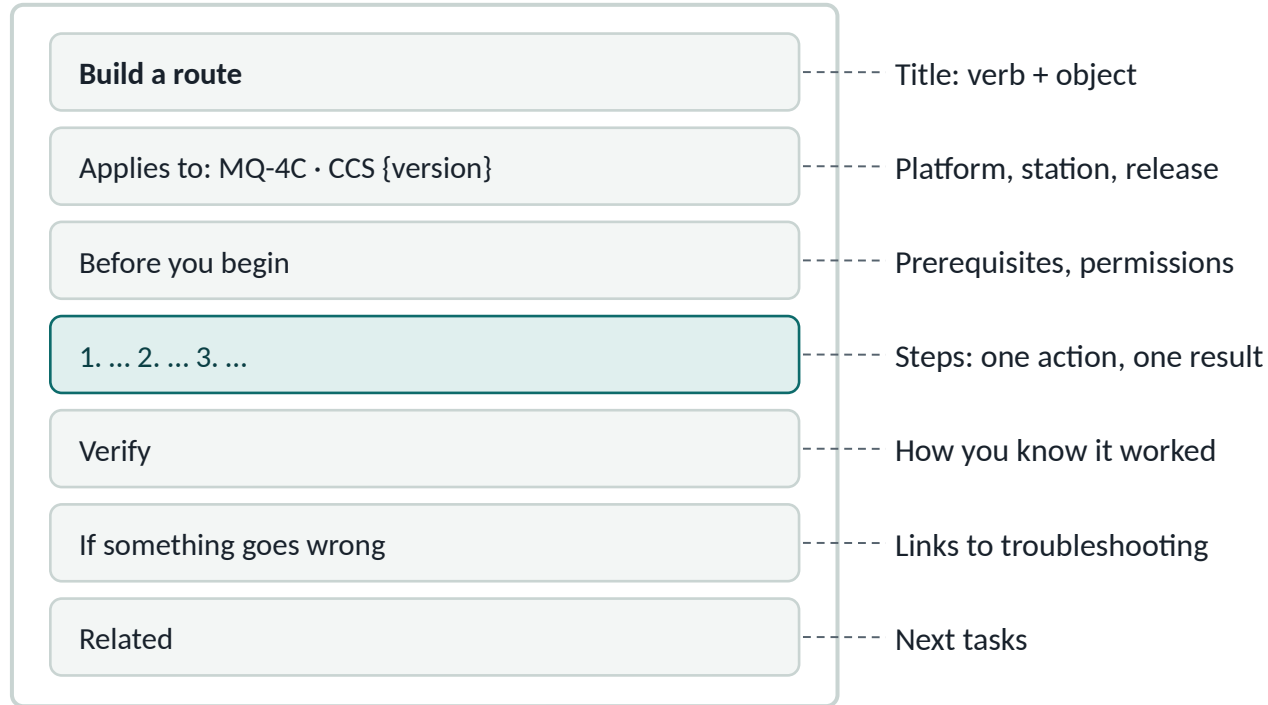
Guide catalog

Grouped by CCS function; reader in the last column

GROUP	GUIDES	READER
Getting started	Log in · Start a session · Hand off control · Log off	Operator
Mission Planning	Create a mission · Build a route · Add tasks · Validate · Re-plan in flight	Operator
Vehicle Management	Establish link · Preflight · Launch · Monitor health · Recover · Transfer control	Operator
Mission Management	Task a sensor · Set priorities · Route products to consumers	Operator
Contingencies	Lost link · Station failover · Emergency recovery	Operator, supervisor
Administration	Install a release · Configure site settings · Back up plans	Site admin

Anatomy of a How-To

Every guide uses the same seven parts, in the same order



Example: Build a route

Illustrative only — generic UI, not the actual CCS interface

Applies to: all platforms • CCS {ccs-version}

Before you begin: an open mission plan.

1. In Mission Planning, select **Route > New**.

The route editor opens on the map.

2. Click the map to place each waypoint.
3. Enter altitude and speed for each leg.
4. Select **Validate**.

Conflicts appear in red.

5. Select **Save**.

Verify: the route shows in the mission tree.

Bold UI labels

exactly as on screen

Italic results

what the operator should see

{ccs-version}

a key; filled at build

≤ 10 steps

longer tasks split in two

Writing rules

What makes a How-To usable mid-mission

Start with a verb

“Select Save,” not “The Save button should be selected.”

One action per step

Two actions = two steps. Results go in their own line.

Warnings before the step

A WARNING or CAUTION comes before the action it protects, conref'd from the library.

Match the screen

UI labels in bold, spelled and capitalized exactly as displayed.

Screenshots sparingly

Only to orient; each one costs a re-capture every release.

Platform differences inline

Tag the differing step with @platform; don't fork the guide.

One guide, three platform builds

Only the tagged step changes

1 Select Route > New. @platform=all

2 Place waypoints on the map. @platform=all

3a Set altitude and airspeed per leg. @platform=mq25 mq4c

3b Set depth and speed per leg. @platform=uuv

4 Select Validate, then Save. @platform=all

MQ-25 build

steps 1, 2, 3a, 4

MQ-4C build

steps 1, 2, 3a, 4

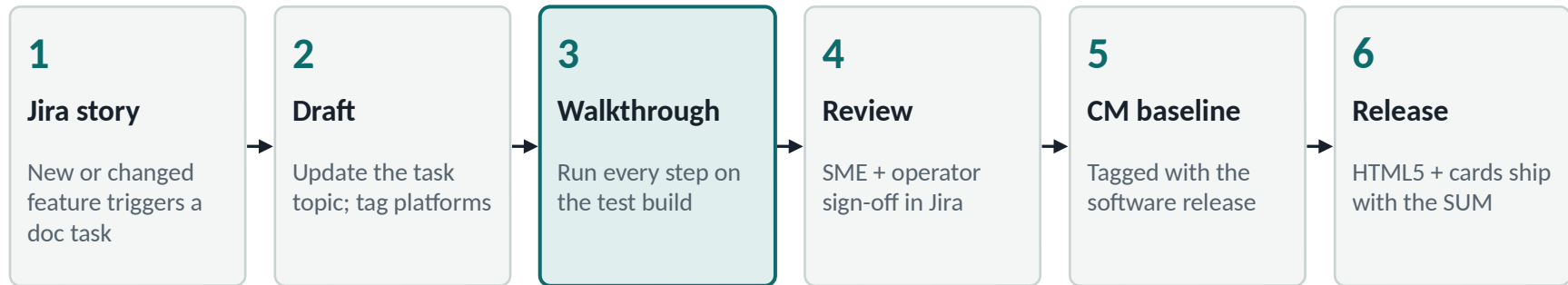
UUV build

steps 1, 2, 3b, 4

Step numbers renumber automatically in each build.

From Jira story to the station

Each guide follows the software release



Walkthrough is the step that matters most. A How-To that hasn't been run on the actual build is a guess. Every step is performed on the test build, and every result line matches what the screen really shows, before review.

Delivery formats

Where operators actually meet the guides

PRIMARY

Offline HTML5 help

Searchable on the station, no network or server needed

TRAINING, BACKUP

Printable task cards

One guide per card, for training and the console

CM RECORD

PDF compilation

All guides in one file, for review and distribution media

Markings: CUI banners and the designation block come from the output templates, so every card and page is marked the same way.

Open questions for the program

1

Are How-To Guides a separate CDRL, or part of the SUM delivery?

2

Which tasks do operators ask about most? That sets the first 10.

3

Can writers get time on a test build for walkthroughs?

4

Are printed task cards allowed at the stations?

5

Who signs off: SMEs, fleet operators, or both?

6

Should guides follow ASD-STE100?